words which arose from suspicions of his eldest son, and accused him of giving him poison'. According to Badauni Akbar then said to Salim:

> Shaikhu Baba, since all this Sultanate will devolve on you,why have you made this attack on me…
> To take away my life there was no need of injustice
> I would have given it to thee if thou hadst asked me

Akbar even began to suspect the physician Hakim Humam, previously above suspicion, of having poisoned him. Death by poisoning was an old fear, one that the Mughal Padshahs would try to guard against with increasingly elaborate rituals. With Akbar seemingly close to death Salim, according to Badauni, then appointed some of his close allies to spy on his brother Murad. When Akbar recovered, the women of the harem and Murad himself complained to the Padshah about Salim's offensive behaviour, and Akbar realized that he could no longer keep his three sons under his claustrophobic care.

The three princes were young men now, with families of their own, and powerful connections through marriage. Murad, especially, married to the daughter of Mirza Aziz Koka, would have been considered a potentially dangerous threat to Salim. Akbar decided that it was finally time to separate his sons to try and diffuse the increasing tension of their close proximity. Murad was appointed Governor of Malwa and given 'pennant, kettle drum, martial music, and a royal standard and all the paraphernalia of royalty'. He was also given 'a royal sleeveless dress of honour, which is an honour conferred only on princes', specified Badauni. Akbar gave him detailed instructions on how to conduct himself during this first major trial of his life. He was to be moderate in his behaviour, his food and drink, his sleep, and his interactions. Leniency and clemency were advised: 'A frown will effect with many what in other men requires a sword and dagger' and 'if apologies are made, accept them'. Murad was encouraged to surround himself with good people, and to listen to their advice. He was to 'secure the affection of contented hermits and of the matted-haired and barefooted' and 'not lose sight of an old servant'. Murad thus went off in resplendent state, attended by noblemen and the advice of his father, first to Malwa, then to Gujarat, and finally to the Deccan. Many ambitious members of the ruling clans and soldiers joined him, believing him 'superior to the other princes in majesty and pomp'.